Din Sopheak Panha

Robotics and Automation Engineer
Autonomous Mobile Robot Navigation and Path Tracking

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Autonomous mobile robots, navigation, path tracking, teleoperation, shared control under communication delay, human-robot collaboration.

EDUCATION

2021 to 2026 **Engineer's Degree in Robotics and Automation Engineering**,

Department: Industrial and Mechanical Engineering, Institute of Technology of Cambodia, Phnom Penh, Cambodia

GPA: 3.5 / 4.0 overall

Language of instruction: English

Relevant coursework (all grade A): AI and Machine Learning, Sensing and Perception, Introduction to Control Theory, Feedback Control Systems, Automation and Industrial Robotics, Signals and Systems, Linear Algebra, Probability

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

2026 **Sopheak Panha Din**, Sarot Srang, Sela Van. Design and integration of a lookahead-based path tracking system for a three-wheel swerve-drive robot using ROS 2. Submitted to the *6th International Conference on Robotics, Automation, and Artificial Intelligence (RAAI 2026)*, Singapore.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2026 to present · Active Projects

- **Shared control teleoperation under communication delay (independent research, in progress)**: when an operator drives a mobile robot remotely, network delay makes commands and sensor data arrive late and collisions more likely. Developing shared control, where the robot adds collision-avoidance assistance to the operator's commands, that still works under delay, in a ROS 2 and Gazebo simulation.

2025 to 2026 · Institute of Technology of Cambodia, Dynamics and Control Laboratory (DCLab)

- **Lookahead-based path tracking for a three-wheel swerve-drive robot (2026)**: PID path tracking on a swerve-drive robot needs separate controllers for x, y and heading that must be retuned for each path. Designed a lookahead-based controller that drives the robot toward a point ahead on the path as a velocity vector, with feedforward heading control and a corner-aware speed limit, using LiDAR-inertial localization. As a result, it tracked square, circle and triangle paths with RMS cross-track errors of 0.77 to 1.09 cm (2.89 cm on a star path) at up to 1.5 m/s, with one fixed parameter set.
- **Implementation of Nav2 for autonomous indoor delivery robot (thesis, 2026)**: implemented the Nav2 navigation stack on a custom-built differential-drive robot, enabling it to map a classroom, localize itself, and navigate to goal positions while avoiding obstacles absent from the original map. Integrated SLAM Toolbox, Adaptive Monte Carlo localization (AMCL), a Smac 2D planner, and a Vector Pursuit path-tracking controller. Achieved the goal in all 10 trials with no collisions, with a mean position error of 0.256 m without and 0.260 m with added obstacles.

2025 · ECAM LaSalle, France (exchange semester)

- **Face tracking teleoperation with SO-ARM101**: hands-free control of a robot arm without the usual second leader arm. Facial landmarks from a single webcam map head yaw, head pitch and mouth opening to the base, wrist and gripper at 60 Hz, with a deadband that removes head jitter so the arm holds still. Led the team as Scrum Master.

2025 · Machine Learning

- **Child malnutrition prediction from household survey data**: predicted child malnutrition in 9,099 Cambodian households from 17 living-condition indicators of the Cambodia Demographic and Health Survey. Trained a shallow and a deep neural network in PyTorch with class weights for the imbalanced data, and compared them with K-Means clustering. The deep network detected 82% of malnourished households (ROC-AUC 0.78), while K-Means could not separate the two groups.

2026 · Industrial Automation

- **Sequence variation system with an ABB robot arm**: pick-and-place cell programmed in RAPID, plus a conveyor sorting system with a Siemens PLC and HMI (TIA Portal V18).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2026 to 2027	**Robotics Tutor**, STEAMING Cambodia. Built the 12-session Micro:Bit Innovators Program single-handedly and teach a Robotics and IoT class with the ESP32.
2026	**Relay Protection Testing Engineer**, SNKRP. Supported senior engineers in testing substation protection relays with an OMICRON CMC 356 and helped prepare test reports.
2026	**Robotics Tutor**, Seksaa Tech Academy. Taught electronics and micro:bit programming to young learners.
2025 to 2026	**Robotics Engineer (part-time)**, Happy Sprouts. Designed the electrical system for a 6-DOF mushroom-harvesting robot prototype (gantry with a SCARA arm), integrating ROS 2 with STM32 controllers and closed-loop stepper drivers over CAN bus. The prototype moves as designed and automatic harvesting is not yet complete.
2025	**Engineering Intern**, Startec Dynamics (Calypso Motors). Built a GPS, IMU and ESP32 motorbike tracking unit that detects possible accidents. Deployed code from the development team onto motorbikes, tested it, and reported the results back to the technical and bike development teams.
2023	**Engineering Intern**, AI Farm. Designed closed-loop stepper motor control for a robot arm on STM32, using PID with encoder feedback.

COMPETITIONS, LEADERSHIP & MEMBERSHIPS

2025	**Team Leader, ITC01**, ABU Robocon 2025, Institute of Technology of Cambodia. Coordinated the mechanical, electronics, and software teams, collaborated on the programming and integration of both robots, and contributed to the hardware design of motor driver, controller shield, and pneumatic valve PCBs for the electronic system.
2024	**Electronics Team Member, ITC02**, ABU Robocon 2024, Dynamics and Control Laboratory (DCLab), Institute of Technology of Cambodia. Assisted with PCB assembly, soldering, robot wiring and hardware integration.
2023 to present	**Member**, Dynamics and Control Laboratory (DCLab)

SKILLS

Programming	C/C++, Python, MATLAB
Robotics & Simulation	ROS 2 (Humble), Nav2, SLAM Toolbox, FAST-LIO2, Gazebo, RViz2
Vision & AI	YOLO, OpenCV, dlib, PyTorch, scikit-learn
Industrial Automation	Siemens TIA Portal (V18), ABB RobotStudio, PLC Programming, HMI Design, Ladder Logic, RAPID
Hardware & Embedded	3D LiDAR (Livox Mid-360), 2D LiDAR, Depth Cameras (Intel RealSense), IMU, CAN bus, NVIDIA Jetson, STM32, ESP32, Raspberry Pi/Orange Pi, Arduino
Tools & OS	Linux (Ubuntu), LaTeX, AutoCAD
Languages	Khmer (native), English (IELTS 6.0, Competent User, July 2022), French (intermediate)

REFERENCES

Asst. Prof. Dr. Sarot Srang, Head of DCLab and ECAM Engineering Program, ITC · srangsarot@itc.edu.kh

Mr. Kann Teudom, Head of STEM Education, STEAMING Cambodia · pdomsc@gmail.com